



Incident handler's journal

Date: 01/24/25	Entry: #1
Description	Documenting a cybersecurity incident. An Incident occurred on a small U.S. health care clinic, attackers (a group of unethical hackers) targeted employees with phishing emails that contained malicious attachments packed with malware used to gain access to the system, consequently they performed a ransomware attack and encrypted all patient data while demanding a payment in return for the decryption key.
Tool(s) used	None.
The 5 W's	• Who: An organized group of unethical hackers. • What: A ransomware attack. • Where: At a small U.S. health care clinic. • When: Tuesday 9:00 a.m. • Why: The clinic was targeted because of monetary motivations, attackers asked for a large sum of money to restore access.
Additional notes	1. To prevent this incident from happening again, the company should focus on employee training and awareness regarding social engineering attacks. Also secure they're environment by implementing controls like policies that could reduce the chance of an event like this occurring again. 2. The is no guarantee that if the company paid the threat actors, they would act on their promise, it is a risk worth evaluating.

Date: 02/26/2025	Entry: #2
Description	Investigating a phishing alert about a suspicious file being downloaded.
Tool(s) used	Playbook.
The 5 W's	• Who: A potential hacker. • What: A phishing attack. • When: July 20, 2022, 09:30:14 AM. • Where: In a financial services company. • Why: A hacker targeted an employee with a phishing E-mail, that contained a malicious file, the user might have clicked or opened the malicious file, escalation of the matter is required. The attacker's motivation is unclear but we suspect that the malicious actor or actors are trying to steal sensitive information or download malicious software or code on the recipient's device, for personal gain.
Additional notes	1. The financial company could prevent this kind of attack from working by teaching employees about phishing emails. 2. A firewall rule that filters unwanted emails should be installed and consider implementing e-mail security controls like DMARC.

Date: 03/04/2025	Entry: #3
Description	Investigating how an individual was able to gain unauthorized access to customer personal identifiable information (PII) and financial information.

Tool(s) used	None.
The 5 W's	• Who: A singular hacker. • What: A DDoS attack, forced browsing attack. • When: 13 p.m., PT, on December 22, 2022. • Where: At a retail company. • Why: There was a vulnerability in the e-commerce web application. This vulnerability allowed the attacker to perform a forced browsing attack and access customer transaction data by modifying the order number included in the URL string of a purchase confirmation page. This vulnerability allowed the attacker to access customer purchase confirmation pages, exposing customer data, which the attacker then collected and exfiltrated. The hacker had monetary motivations, asking for a payment in exchange of not sharing client PII.
Additional notes	To prevent future recurrences, we are taking the following actions: 1. Perform routine vulnerability scans and penetration testing. 2. Implement allowlisting to allow access to a specified set of URLs and automatically block all requests outside of this URL range. 3. Ensure that only authenticated users are authorized access to content.

Date: 19/05/2025	Entry: 4
Description	Identifying whether there are any possible security issues with the mail server, at the e-commerce store Buttercup Games.

Tool(s) used	Splunk.
The 5 W's	• Who: Client or worker. • What: Failed login attempts. • When: All time, example: 08/09/2022 18:13:34. • Where: At the e-commerce store Buttercup Games. • Why: Incorrect credentials, network issues, firewall problems, or, more commonly, attempts at brute-force attacks.
Additional notes	1. Promote multi factor authentication for clients, vendors and employees. 2. Check firewall rules.

Date: 10/06/2025	Entry: #5
Description	Investigate a suspicious file hash.
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal. (An investigative tool that analyzes information to determine if it's malicious.) It was used to investigate the generated file hash.
The 5 W's	• Who: An unknown attacker via phishing. • What: An email sent to an employee that contained a file and a password, when the employee opened the file using the password a malicious payload was executed on his computer. A file hash was created for investigation: "54e6ea47eb04634d3e87fd7787e2136ccfbcc80ade34f246a12cf93bab527f6b".

	• When: At 1:20 P.M, the file was detected by the organization's IDS that sent an alert to the SOC. • Where: At a financial services company, on an employee's computer. • Why: The employee was tricked to open the malicious file on his computer. The attacker's motivation is being investigated due to the nature of the malware.
Additional notes	There should be a focus on security awareness and training to prevent future attacks, the human factor is the most targeted and vulnerable asset in an organization.